Lesson 3 — The Night the Network Failed

Part 11 of 12: Answer key and teacher notes

Level: A2 (third step)

About 10 minutes · this part carries a sheet

Listening: L1 — Omar, software engineering · L2 — uploading his files to the college server · L3 — a copy he had sent to his own email · L4 — two days old (from Sunday)

Part A (MCQ): 1-B · 2-B · 3-C · 4-A · 5-C · 6-C · 7-D · 8-B

Why 7 is [D]: the sentence says the copy opened, so it can only follow "The copy was from Sunday. It was two days old." At [C]** it would contradict the broken file described just before it.

Why 8 is [B]**: the teacher's words are what make Omar think of his email, so that paragraph exists to explain how he found the second copy — not to describe Omar, and not to blame the college.

Part B (True/False):

1. F — He was studying software engineering.
2. T
3. F — Omar was not laughing.
4. T
5. F — It was from Sunday.
6. T

Part C (Fill in the blanks): 1. project · 2. server · 3. stuck, per cent · 4. cable, browser · 5. broken · 6. Save (Extra words: version, careful)

2.4 A (Opposites): 1. download · 2. careless · 3. working / fine · 4. quiet / silent · 5. start / begin

2.4 B (Odd one out): 1. evening (the others are computer words) · 2. project (the others are things you can touch) · 3. careful (the others mean damaged or not moving)

3.6 A (Past continuous): 1. was sitting · 2. were working · 3. was writing · 4. Were … laughing · 5. was not laughing 3.6 B (Simple or continuous): 1. was uploading, stopped · 2. was, were talking · 3. found, was looking

Mini-quiz: 1. was working · 2. were laughing · 3. when, while · 4. download · 5. careless · 6. server · 7. browser · 8. stuck · 9–12. teacher judgement

Teacher Notes

What changed from Lesson 2. The passage grew from 244 to 320 words, the past continuous joins the past simple, and an eighth question type — purpose of a paragraph — joins sentence insertion. The pronunciation slot moves from the three sounds of -ed to the weak forms of was and were. The order of

the sessions, the self-report and the six original TOEFL question types are deliberately unchanged, so only one thing is new at a time.

The one real difficulty. Not the form — was + -ing is easy to build — but knowing when to choose it. Arabic marks the progressive past differently, so the student will reach for the past simple everywhere and say while I worked, the power stopped. Drill the pair in 3.4 until while automatically pulls -ing behind it.

Why this story. The vocabulary is the vocabulary of her actual working life: server, upload, browser, version, save. She is about to carry application files, scans and transcripts between machines, and the passage teaches that problem while teaching the tense. It is also the third story in a row in which the lesson is keep a second copy — that repetition is intentional.

Success criteria for Lesson 3. The student should be able to:

- answer L1–L4 correctly on the second hearing;
- retell the story in 5–6 sentences using at least two past-continuous verbs;
- choose correctly between past simple and past continuous in 3.6 B;
- hear the difference between weak and strong was;
- use 10 of the 14 key words in her own sentence;
- write 10 sentences about a personal past event with fewer than 4 tense errors.

If it is too easy: Lesson 4 goes to 400 words, adds the present perfect (I have saved it), and the MCQ set adds a rhetorical-purpose question about the whole passage. If it is too hard: keep the same passage for a second week, drop question 8, and drill only 3.1 and 3.4.

A note on spaced recall. `03-vocabulary.mp3` ends with five Lesson 1 words — check, centre, tool, slow, wake up — which are the five she has not heard since Lesson 1, because Lesson 2 recalled the other five. Lesson 2's own words come back in Lesson 4. Keep that two-lesson gap: it is the gap, not the repetition, that moves a word into long-term memory.